

Checklist

Engineering Executive: Personal & Organizational Prestige

Decide If You Even Need to Invest

- ☐ Can I **hire senior candidates** successfully?
- ☐ Do people **seek my advice beyond my direct reports**?
- ☐ Can I **start interview processes** for the roles I want?
- ☐ Do **executive recruiters** bring me interesting roles?
- ☐ Is **my network naturally expanding** to more senior people?

If mostly “yes” → **minimal investment needed.**

If mostly “no” → **build prestige deliberately.**

Understand the Goal

- ☐ I am optimizing for ***prestige*** (passive positive awareness), not audience size.
- ☐ I understand **prestige ≠ brand ≠ followers**.
- ☐ I will **avoid over-investing** in content volume.

Choose a Timeless, High-Leverage Topic

- ☐ I have a meaningful, **non-obvious perspective**.
- ☐ The topic will remain **relevant for years** to come.
- ☐ The insight **adds depth**, not controversy.
- ☐ It reflects **real experience** and accomplishment.

Pick the Right Format

- ☐ Blog post **or** conference talk (preferred).
- ☐ Small enough to iterate quickly.
- ☐ Creates a permanent, discoverable artifact.
- ☐ Not a book or podcast (unless intentional and strategic).

Create High-Quality Content

- ☐ I expect to discard 2-3 drafts.
- ☐ I've gotten feedback from experienced reviewers.
- ☐ Readers can clearly articulate my key insight.
- ☐ Some thoughtful disagreement is possible (a good sign).

Distribute Simply

- ☐ I asked 5-10 peers to share it simultaneously.
- ☐ I shared it thoughtfully in relevant communities.
- ☐ I avoided controversy-driven promotion.

Make It Discoverable

- ☐ It lives on a personal website.
- ☐ It's linked from LinkedIn or professional profiles.
- ☐ It's easy to find via search.
- ☐ Future content is collected in one place.

Repeat (Lightly)

- ☐ I'll repeat this 2-3 times over several years.
- ☐ I will prioritize quality over frequency.
- ☐ I won't build a heavy content machine.

Avoid Bad Metrics

Do **not** optimize for:

- ☐ Pageviews
- ☐ Social media followers
- ☐ Content volume
- ☐ Sales (if prestige is the goal)

Instead:

- ☐ Timebox effort.
- ☐ Notice whether content comes up in interviews or hiring conversations.
- ☐ Observe whether opportunities expand naturally.

For Organizations

- ☐ Focus on meaningful, attractive engineering problems.
- ☐ Highlight prestigious employees or work.
- ☐ Produce a small amount of thoughtful, high-quality content.
- ☐ Avoid high-frequency publishing strategies.

The Core Principle

Prestige = Ambient, positive, easily discoverable familiarity.

- ☐ Small amount.
- ☐ High quality.
- ☐ Timeless insight.
- ☐ Easily discoverable.

☐ Repeated occasionally.